

Jade Zhao

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Digital Humans · AI · human-centered business technology.

When an AI system looks and communicates like a person, what makes people use it, trust it, and keep using it?

EDUCATION

Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering at Indiana University

Bloomington, IN

B.S. Informatics (Business & Society)

Expected Graduation: May 2027

Minors: Business Technology; UX Research. **Scholarships:** Hudson & Holland Platinum Scholar (full merit); GPA **3.50**; first-generation.

Relevant Coursework: HCI (human-computer interaction), databases, information systems, software engineering, data privacy.

Universidad Complutense de Madrid (UCM)

Madrid, Spain

*Study abroad · own school · Luddy / Hutton International Experiences
Programme (HIEP)*

Spring 2026

Coursework: systems friction, cross-cultural UX (user experience), public-service AI ethics.

EXPERIENCE

Luddy LINK, Indiana University - Digital Humans Project Lead

Feb 2025 to present

- **Luddy LINK** (applied technology projects at Luddy): research AI-driven virtual personas as business interfaces. Core question: when an AI system looks and communicates like a person, what makes people use it, trust it, and keep using it? Family restaurant → Informatics → Serve IT ships → UX / privacy → Digital Humans puts the pieces together.
- Frame trust, disclosure, and human handoff as product requirements, not footnotes. Stakeholder translation between research questions and what a partner can actually use after the demo.

City of Bloomington & Nashville, IN - Website Team Lead · Nashville ACC Co-lead

Jan 2024 to present

- **Five documented ServeIT handoffs** (Luddy nonprofit technology clinic): **Spring 2024** City of Bloomington website and accessibility (**WCAG 2.1**); **Fall 2024** Middle Way House; **Spring 2025** Indiana Phenology; **Fall 2025** Greater Bloomington Chamber; **Fall 2026** Town of Nashville ACC (accessibility assessment; recommendations only).
- **Website Team Lead:** intake, scoping, and stakeholder handoff. **Python** and **PostgreSQL ETL** from partner **Excel** into **relational** schemas, with completeness checks before staff take over.

Public Interest Technology University Network (PIT-UN) - Business Technologist

May 2024 to Dec 2024

- Researched **agentic AI** for organisations without in-house engineering: adoption barriers and what has to survive after a pilot (a human owner, not a demo-only system). Distinct from ServeIT.

Potstickers, New Palestine, IN - Customer service / communications

May 2017 to Jun 2023

- Floor, till, and kitchen: guest-facing **customer service** and staff **communications** under Friday-night pressure. A system either survives contact with a real customer or it does not.

Bamboo Gardens Buffet, Greenfield, IN - Web & digital builder

May 2017 to Jun 2023

- Self-taught website and social rebuild after COVID-19; supported online ordering / POS (point of sale). Turned unstructured menu copy into a maintainable public site.

PROJECTS

Handshake Content Creator | *influencer* · Aug 2023 to present

- Handshake influencer and content creator: practical early-career posts on workplace norms, professional communication, and career decisions for student audiences.

SKILLS

Programming languages: Python, SQL, JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, HTML/CSS, LaTeX

Spoken languages: English, Fuzhounese, Spanish

Data & tools: PostgreSQL, ETL/ELT, Git, GitHub, REST APIs (JSON), Excel, Planner/Teams

Secondary: React, Node.js, WordPress, Figma

Concepts: Digital Humans, HCI, disclosure, human oversight, databases, internal systems, IT, data pipelines, WCAG 2.1, privacy/UX